MODULE 00 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional

SAP-C03. What the exam tests, what changed from C02, and how this course is built.

EXAM SAP-C03 QUESTIONS 75 in 180 min PASS 720 of 1000

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Who this exam is for

- **Two or more years** designing and implementing solutions on AWS is AWS's recommendation.
- **Designs span many applications** in a complex, multi-account organisation.
- **New in C03:** serverless and **AI-integrated architectures** are named in the target candidate.
- **It tests judgement, not recall.** Most questions have two defensible answers.

> ON THE EXAM
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> The deciding detail is usually one clause in a long scenario. This course trains you to find it.

The format, precisely

- **75 questions in 180 minutes.** 65 are scored; 10 are unscored and not identified.
- **Scaled from 100 to 1,000, with 720 to pass.** Scoring is compensatory.
- **Multiple response needs every correct option.** No partial credit.
- **Unanswered scores as incorrect**, and guessing carries no penalty.

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> 720 is not 72%. Scaled scoring means the cut score cannot be converted to a number of questions.

The five domains

DOMAIN	WEIGHT	WHAT IT IS REALLY ABOUT
1 Architecture built for the cloud	25%	Events, containers, networks, data, and AI
2 Security, compliance, governance	25%	Identity, perimeters, keys, guardrails
3 Cost-optimized architecture	15%	Commitments, right-sizing, AI and transfer cost
4 Resilience, migration, continuity	15%	Disaster recovery, chaos testing, migration
5 Operational excellence, automation	20%	IaC, pipelines, observability, self-healing

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Domains 1 and 2 carry half the exam. AI appears in all five, not as a domain of its own.

What the exam does not expect

- **Training or fine-tuning models**, and data science workflows.
- **Security incident forensics** and detailed threat investigation.
- **In-depth operating system knowledge.**
- **Application code development** and debugging.

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> The line for AI is drawn at architecture: inference, RAG, agents, guardrails and observability are in.

If you studied for C02

- **Reorganised by concern**: architecture, security, cost, resilience, operations.
- **Four C02 out-of-scope calls reversed**: VPC Lattice, FIS, Resilience Hub, ARC.
- **Many services left the in-scope list**, including Migration Hub, Snowball, Macie and Detective.
- Modules 50 and 51 cover every change and every closed or renamed service.

> ON THE EXAM
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> C02's last exam day was 16 November 2026. Some correct C02 answers are now distractors.

How this course was built

- **The C03 exam guide was read in full**, and modules map to its numbered skills.
- **Every fact was checked against current AWS documentation** in November 2026.
- **A question bank was used as a topic map only.** No question from it appears here.
- **Every scenario and practice question is original.**

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> Where AWS changed something after the guide's sources were written, the module says so and gives the date.

How to read the slides

- **The coloured marker on a bullet is a signal**: key fact, nuance, or trap.
- **The boxed line at the foot** is the exam-facing point, often a tiebreaker.
- **The bar down the left edge** shows which domain you are in.
- Narration carries the reasoning; the slide carries the structure.

> ON THE EXAM
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> Nothing important is on a slide and missing from the narration, so the course works as audio too.

Worked scenarios, and the pause

- **Every teaching module ends with six worked scenarios** at exam difficulty.
- **When the narration says pause, pause**, and commit to an answer.
- **Every option is explained**, including why the wrong ones fail.
- Watching without answering first feels productive and teaches very little.

> ON THE EXAM
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> 312 worked scenarios and 150 practice questions. They are the part that moves your score.

The course at a glance

SECTION	MODULES	ABOUT
Domain 1: architecture	01 to 13	2h 46m
Domain 2: security	14 to 24	2h 00m
Domain 3: cost	25 to 31	1h 09m
Domain 4: resilience and migration	32 to 39	1h 16m
Domain 5: operations	40 to 48	1h 20m
Cross-cutting: pairs, changes, technique	49 to 52	0h 39m
Practice: five domain papers and a mock	PE1 to PE6	2h 30m

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About 9 hours 10 minutes of teaching, and 11 hours 40 minutes with the practice exams.

Finding your way around

IF YOU WANT	GO TO
Generative AI, RAG and agents	Modules 06, 07, 24, 27, 47
Networking, hybrid and DNS	Modules 08 to 11
Identity, keys and guardrails	Modules 14 to 20
Disaster recovery and chaos testing	Modules 37 to 39
Pipelines, deployments and observability	Modules 40 to 48
Final-week revision	Modules 49 to 52, then the mock

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Chapter marks on the video give each module's start time.

A study route

- **Watch modules 01 to 52 in order.** Later modules build on earlier ones.
- **Sit each domain paper** after finishing its domain, and rewatch behind your misses.
- **Sit the full mock in one session**, close to exam day.
- **Count correct guesses as misses.** Otherwise the score flatters you.

> ON THE EXAM
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> Every practice paper ends with a table mapping each question to the module that teaches it.

Two notes on language

- **The prose is British:** organisation, optimise, licence, centre.
- **AWS names keep their US spelling**: Cost-Optimized, AWS Organizations.
- That mix is deliberate, so names match what you see in the console.
- **Depth is set for passing the exam**, not for implementation.

> ON THE EXAM
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> Every module ends with a recap slide. Those recaps make good revision notes.

Module 01 opens Domain 1 with **event-driven architecture** and the delivery guarantees the exam keeps testing.